

a program for scheduling from the list it provides, or you can use the 'Browse' button to locate a program of your choice. 'System Restore' is present in the displayed list; select it and click 'Next'. Enter a name for the schedule, say 'Restore Point', and choose the frequency at which you want to run the schedule from the 'Perform this Task' list: 'Daily', 'Weekly', 'Monthly', 'One time only', 'When computer starts' and 'When I log on'.

Let's choose 'Weekly' and proceed with the wizard. Specify the time (10:00 AM in our example) and a day of the week (say Friday) in the following screen. Enter your username and password when asked for, and click 'Next' to finish adding the schedule. You may choose to open 'Advanced Properties' at the end of the Wizard, but this isn't necessary unless the task demands advanced settings.

4.6.11 System

Managing your computer becomes easy from within the System Properties. Double-click on the 'System' icon to open System Properties. This dialog box contains seven tabs—General, Hardware, Advanced, Computer Name, System Restore, Automatic Updates and Remote. The tabs for Hardware and Advanced rank high in order of importance.

The '**Hardware**' tab contains features such as the Device Manager, which lists all the devices in and attached to your computer, and also provides you with details about them—for example, whether they're operational, or whether there are conflicts or driver issues. These can be easily identified—Device Manager indicates malfunctioning devices with an exclamation mark.

The '**Advanced**' tab includes settings for Startup and Recovery, User Profiles, and Performance. Most users who know Windows XP well use the Performance settings to configure their systems for faster operation. The most common performance tuning is assigning a fixed range for virtual memory on a FAT32 partition. You'll find more tips for tweaking using Advanced Options in Chapter 8.